PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

2023 Exam-Style Practice Paper

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences (the Strategic Hamlet Program in South Vietnam in 1962):

• **Inference 1:** The forced relocation of rural peasants caused widespread resentment against the South Vietnamese government.

- *Detail from source:* "alienates the rural population. Peasants resent being relocated from their traditional lands."

• **Inference 2:** The program backfired by driving hostile villagers into secretly supporting the Vietcong.

- *Detail from source:* "Consequently, many villagers secretly cooperate with the Vietcong due to their hostility toward the resettlement program."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

Target: AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

“One reason why the USA was involved in the peace negotiations (1972–73) about the war in Vietnam was President Nixon's need to implement Vietnamisation and fulfill his election promises.” Nixon was elected in 1968 after promising to achieve 'peace with honour'. His policy of **Vietnamisation** aimed to withdraw US troops while training and equipping South Vietnamese forces to defend themselves, ending direct US combat involvement. *Therefore, Nixon's political commitment to the American electorate was a primary reason why the USA was involved in the peace negotiations (1972–73) about the war in Vietnam because a negotiated treaty was the only way to withdraw troops honorably.*

“A second reason why the USA was involved in the peace negotiations (1972–73) about the war in Vietnam was that the USA realized that a military victory was impossible due to the resilience of communist supply routes.” Despite massive bombing campaigns like Operation Linebacker, the Vietcong and North Vietnamese Army continued to receive supplies along the **Ho Chi Minh Trail** through Cambodia and Laos. The trail's resilience meant that US military power could not force a communist surrender, resulting in a prolonged deadlock. *Therefore, the failure to sever communist lines of supply was a key reason why the USA was involved in the peace negotiations (1972–73) about the war in Vietnam because it forced the Nixon administration to accept that a diplomatic settlement was the only realistic exit.*

“A third reason why the USA was involved in the peace negotiations (1972–73) about the war in Vietnam was the immense economic burden of the conflict and changing global relations.” The war cost the USA over **$100 billion**, causing high inflation. At the same time, Nixon pursued a policy of **détente** with the Soviet Union and rapprochement with China, hoping to pressure North Vietnam to negotiate. *Therefore, financial pressures and the pursuit of détente were vital reasons why the USA was involved in the peace negotiations (1972–73) about the war in Vietnam because they made ending the war highly desirable for US global strategy.*

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for demonstrating the positive, empowering impact of the Freedom Summer on local Black communities in Mississippi. Gandy recalls that the campaign was a "turning point" that made local residents realize they "had constitutional rights" and inspired them to stage their own boycotts and protests. This content is highly useful because it is supported by my knowledge that the SNCC and CORE volunteers established 30 Freedom Schools throughout Mississippi, which educated over 3,000 Black children and adults, fostering grassroots political awareness and self-determination. The provenance of a recollection from a local Black resident who attended a Freedom School as a child in 1964 increases its usefulness because it provides a first-hand perspective of the psychological empowerment experienced by the local population. However, it was recorded in 2015, meaning it may be influenced by decades of hindsight and the heroic narrative of the civil rights movement, which could gloss over the immediate fear and divisions at the time.

Source C is highly useful for showing the extreme violence, intimidation, and state-level opposition faced by civil rights volunteers. The log records numerous incidents of white hostility, including the firebombing of churches and homes of activists, arrests of volunteers, and the disappearance of three civil rights workers in Philadelphia whose car was found burned. This content's utility is verified by my knowledge that the KKK, local police, and White Citizens' Councils worked together to terrorize volunteers, most famously shown by the murder of James Chaney, Andrew Goodman, and Michael Schwerner in Philadelphia, Mississippi, in June 1964, confirming the high level of danger. The provenance makes the source extremely useful because it is a contemporary record compiled by the organizers of the Freedom Summer during June 1964. This represents an immediate, accurate, and unembellished log of events designed for internal security and to alert the federal government, making it a highly reliable record of the systematic violence they suffered.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 argues that the Freedom Summer **"achieved significant educational outcomes"**, such as setting up Freedom Schools and developing leadership. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues the campaign was characterized by **"violence and disappointment"** due to arrests, low voter registration, and racial division.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have given weight to different sources. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which states that "the northern volunteers initiated an important shift", leading to the view that the campaign **"achieved significant educational outcomes"** such as Freedom Schools. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which lists how "dwellings of two civil rights workers damaged" and churches were firebombed, leading to the view that the campaign was characterized by **"violence and disappointment"**.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree to a large extent with Interpretation 2 that the Freedom Summer was characterized by violence and disappointment. Over **1,000** northern volunteers, mostly white, came to Mississippi, which provoked extreme white supremacist violence. As logged in Source C, civil rights workers faced constant terror: **15 people** were killed, dozens of churches were bombed, and hundreds were arrested, including the **damage of dwellings** and the disappearance of activists in Philadelphia. Furthermore, of the 17,000 Black Americans who tried to register, only about **1,600** were successful due to local registrar obstruction. This supports Interpretation 2's argument that the campaign was a **"bitter experience"** that **"caused deep divisions"** between Black activists and white volunteers.

However, Interpretation 1 is also valid in identifying key achievements. The campaign established **41 Freedom Schools** which taught reading, math, and Black history to over **3,000** children. As Lenray Gandy recalls in Source B, the campaign was a **turning point** that inspired local residents to stage boycotts and protests. The national pressure also directly contributed to the passing of the **Voting Rights Act of 1965**, which outlawed literacy tests and transformed southern politics. This supports Interpretation 1's view that the campaign **"achieved significant educational outcomes"** and developed **"local leadership"** so that campaigning could continue.

*Overall, while the internal trauma of the campaign (Interpretation 2) did lead to a split, accelerating the rise of **Black Power** and the expulsion of whites from SNCC in 1966. Yet, while the summer was a 'bitter experience', it was a crucial catalyst that forced federal intervention, meaning its long-term achievements (Interpretation 1) ultimately outweighed its immediate failures.*